

Web Development Starter Guide

By DeVoc

Build your first real webpage using the three basics of web development — no experience needed.

How the Web Works (In 1 Minute)

Every website is built from three parts:

- **HTML** → structure (what's on the page)
- **CSS** → design (how it looks)
- **JavaScript** → behavior (how it reacts)

Think of a body: HTML is the skeleton, CSS is the skin, and JavaScript is the movement.

What You Need

A text editor (Notepad, TextEdit, or the free [VS Code](#)) and a browser you already have. That's it.

Prefer zero setup? Paste the code below into [codepen.io](#) — it runs instantly, split into three matching panels.

Every Site Is 3 Files

Make a folder anywhere on your computer and add three empty files inside it:

- `index.html`
- `style.css`
- `script.js`

Here's what goes in each one.

1. `index.html` — the structure

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>My First Page</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
</head>
```

```
<body>

  <h1>Hello, I'm learning web development</h1>
  <p>This is my first website.</p>

  

  <button id="text-btn">Click Me</button>

  <script src="script.js"></script>

</body>
</html>
```

A **tag** like `<h1>` or `<p>` tells the browser what something is. `src` and `id` are **attributes** — extra info inside a tag; `id` gives an element a unique name so JavaScript can find it later. The `<link>` and `<script>` lines are what connect this file to the other two.

2. **style.css** — the design

```
body {
  font-family: Arial, sans-serif;
  text-align: center;
  background: #f4f4f4;
}

h1 {
  color: #333;
}

img {
  border-radius: 10px;
  margin: 10px;
}

button {
  padding: 10px 20px;
  background: black;
  color: white;
  border: none;
  cursor: pointer;
}
```

```
button:hover {  
  background: #444;  
}
```

Each block targets an element (`h1`, `button`...) and styles it. `margin` adds space around an element, `padding` adds space inside it, and `button:hover` only applies while your mouse is over the button.

3. `script.js` — the behavior

```
document.querySelector("#text-btn").onclick = function() {  
  document.querySelector("p").textContent = "You clicked the button!";  
}
```

This grabs the button by its `id`, and says: when clicked, change the paragraph's text.

See It Work

Double-click `index.html` to open it in your browser. Click the button and watch the text change.

Changed something? Save the file, then refresh the browser (Ctrl/Cmd + R) to see it.

Try One More Thing

Add a second button in `index.html`, right under the first:

```
<button id="color-btn">Change Background</button>
```

Then add this to the bottom of `script.js`:

```
document.querySelector("#color-btn").onclick = function() {  
  document.body.style.background = "#dfe6e9";  
}
```

Save both files, refresh, and try both buttons.

Common Mistakes

- File names don't match exactly (`style.css` vs `Style.css`)
- Forgetting to save before refreshing the browser
- A missing or misspelled `<script>` line

Your Turn

- ☐ Add another paragraph.
- ☐ Add a second image
- ☐ Add a third button that does something new

If you can do this, you've built a real interactive webpage.

You've Learned the Basics

You now know how to structure a page, style it, and make it interactive.

But Real Development Goes Further

Real projects mean bigger features, real logic, and solving problems on your own — that's where most beginners get stuck.

What DeVoc Helps You Do

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